

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1581

By Scarbrough

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate Arnold Justice Wallace on the celebration of his 100th birthday.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to pay tribute to those citizens who are celebrating special occasions in their estimable lives; and

WHEREAS, Arnold Justice Wallace celebrates his 100th birthday on May 9, 2026, a milestone commemorated as yet another precious souvenir of life's rich pageant; and

WHEREAS, born on May 9, 1926, Mr. Wallace spent most of his life in Clinton, Oak Ridge, and Lenoir City, ultimately returning to Clinton in 1976; and

WHEREAS, as a child, Arnold Wallace picked green beans at Carden Farm for six cents a basket and planted cabbage for seventy-five cents a day; in his teenage years, he assisted his uncle, George Hall, a plumber and electrician, from whom he learned the trade; and

WHEREAS, eager to serve his fellow citizens and his nation, Mr. Wallace persuaded his mother to sign his enlistment papers a month before his eighteenth birthday in 1944, following in the footsteps of his father, a World War I veteran; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Wallace joined the Navy during World War II, serving as a gunner on a landing craft support ship stationed in Leyte Gulf Bay, Philippines; these gunboats provided close-in fire and were armed with rockets, guns, and smoke screens to protect troops; and

WHEREAS, as Mr. Wallace and his fellow crewmates prepared for an invasion of Japan, two bombs were dropped, and when the war ended, his unit celebrated by firing every flare and rocket on board; and

WHEREAS, in November 1947, Arnold Wallace began his distinguished forty-year career at X-10 in Oak Ridge, taking his much-deserved retirement after decades of astute service; and

WHEREAS, a highly respected leader in his community, Arnold Wallace has served as a Freemason for sixty-five years, a tradition continued by his son, Kenneth; and

WHEREAS, a gentleman of many talents and interests, Mr. Wallace has been an avid beekeeper since 1980, sharing his knowledge with anyone who is curious enough to ask; he enjoys woodworking and has crafted several oak pie safes, which he donated to Relay for Life fundraisers supporting cancer research; and

WHEREAS, he was also a cattle farmer, carefully tending to his herd and spending countless hours cutting, raking, baling, and stacking hay for winter feed; his commitment extended to meticulously maintaining his farm equipment to keep the fields in prime condition; and

WHEREAS, deeply devoted to his family, Mr. Wallace was joined in holy matrimony with his beloved wife, Ila Wier Hillon Wallace, on April 30, 1948, with whom he shared more than sixty-five years of marriage until her passing in 2013; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Wallace and his wife were active members of the Order of the Eastern Star; Mr. Wallace remains a member of Sinking Springs United Methodist Church; and

WHEREAS, Arnold Wallace continues to be an inspiration to all who have the good fortune of knowing him; he is ever supportive and steadfast in his faith, and his guidance and dedication to family, church, and community are immeasurable; and

WHEREAS, we wish to grasp this golden opportunity to specially recognize one of Tennessee's most outstanding citizens on this very special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate Arnold Justice Wallace on the celebration of his 100th birthday and extend to him our best wishes for much continued success and happiness.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.